QP CODE - **25900327**

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) - REGULAR EXAMINATION OCTOBER 2026 - FIFTH SEMESTER

Skill Enhancement Course (SEC) - MG5SECJMC300, MG5SECPJM301 - Translation and Creative Writing Scheme

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes **Maximum Marks : 50**

PART A — Multiple Choice Questions

1. d). Inviting criticism from the readers
2. d). Transediting
3. c). Machine Translation
4. c). Agricultural crop forecasting
5. d). Formal and Dynamic equivalence
6. c). Visual actions, timing, and sound cues
7. b). Author intent
8. b). Modulation
9. b). Delivering clear, accurate, and timely facts
10. c). Tailoring media content to fit the specific linguistic and cultural norms of a target region
11. c). Creative non-fiction
12. c). Keep It Short and Simple
13. b). Facebook
14. a). Presentation
15. b). Fictionalizing

PART B — Short Answer Questions *(3 Marks)*

16. Explain Catford's Linguistic Theory - Catford's theory defines translation as a formal linguistic substitution of text in one language by equivalent text in another, introducing key concepts like shift and equivalence boundaries. It views translation strictly through a structural, linguistic lens rather than communicative function.

17. Describe the significance of localization in translation - Localization tailors translated content to fit the specific linguistic, cultural, and technical expectations of a target geographic region. It ensures that elements like formats, symbols, and regional norms resonate authentically with local audiences.

18. Explain why human insight matters when translating cultural content - Human insight is essential because AI and algorithms lack lived empathy, intuition, and contextual awareness. Humans alone can decode deep-seated idioms, historical subtexts, humor, and social sensitivities without causing offense.

19. List three applications of machine translation in media production

- Rapid generation of draft subtitles for high-volume video content.
- Initial processing and translation of international news wire dispatches.
- Translating website metadata and multilingual social media posts.

20. What is the role of localization in cultural adaptation? - Localization operationalizes cultural adaptation by transforming abstract cultural concepts into concrete, region-specific realities. It bridges gaps by modifying currencies, idioms, dates, and localized markers to fit target markets.

21. **Briefly explain the core requisites of translation of features** - Feature translation requires capturing stylistic flair, preserving human-interest appeal, and retaining narrative pacing. Translators must balance factual accuracy with descriptive richness rather than relying on strict literalism.

22. **Draft a short note on pre-writing and brainstorming in creative writing** - Pre-writing and brainstorming form the crucial initial stage where writers generate ideas, conduct research, map character arcs, and outline structural plots. This phase establishes direction and momentum before actual drafting begins.

23. **Identify the application of persuasive writing in the field of advertising** -Persuasive writing is applied in advertising to construct compelling value propositions, emotional hooks, and clear calls-to-action (CTAs). It motivates target consumers to change perceptions or purchase products.

PART C — Essay Questions *(15 Marks)*

24. Explain Roman Jakobson's three-fold classification of translation using examples from the media industry.

- **Intralingual Translation (Rewording):** Translating or paraphrasing within the same language, such as modernizing classical news archives or adapting complex scripts for simpler broadcasts.
- **Interlingual Translation (Proper Translation):** Translating between two different natural languages, such as localizing an international English news report into regional Indian languages.
- **Intersemiotic Translation (Transmutation):** Translating verbal signs into non-verbal systems, such as adapting a written investigative feature article or novel into a visual film script or documentary.

25. Explain the main purpose of press releases in organizational communication.

- **Official Information Dissemination:** Serving as the formal, verified channel for corporations or governments to announce news, product launches, or policy updates to media outlets.
- **Brand Image and Narrative Control:** Ensuring that organizational messages, executive quotes, and key data points are communicated accurately and uniformly across public channels.
- **Newsroom Usability:** Providing structured, pre-formatted content (headline, lead, boilerplate) that journalists can easily process, translate, and syndicate into public news stories.

26. Discuss the impact of online translation tools and Artificial Intelligence (Al) on the modern translation industry.

- **Speed and Efficiency:** Neural Machine Translation (NMT) and AI models process massive volumes of text instantly, drastically cutting down production time and costs for global media distribution.
- **Workflow Evolution (PEMTs):** Shifting human roles from scratch-translation to Post-Editing Machine Translation (PEMTs), where humans refine raw AI outputs for cultural nuance and tone.
- **Limitations and Risks:** Highlighting AI's struggle with sarcasm, deep cultural context, and idiomatic humor, alongside data privacy risks when handling confidential corporate translations.

27. Prepare a detailed essay on the core elements of creative writing

- **Plot and Structure:** The logical sequence of events, frameworks (like the Three-Act structure), and narrative arcs that provide momentum and direction to a story.
- **Characterization and Voice:** Crafting multi-dimensional figures with distinct psychological depths, motivations, and establishing a unique authorial tone or acoustic identity.
- **Setting, Conflict, and Theme:** Using sensory descriptions to build atmospheric worlds, introducing central struggles to generate tension, and communicating the underlying philosophical message.